



Bower: The Package Manager for Web Applications

Websites comprise frameworks, libraries, assets and utilities. Keeping track of all these packages and making sure they are up to date (or set to the specific versions you need) is tricky. Bower manages all this for you, seamlessly.

Bower is an open source package manager for Web applications. We need to install a lot of packages while building a website. Bower helps in automatically fetching and installing all these packages. The main objective of Bower is not to minimise code but to install the right version of packages and their dependencies that we require for a project.

Installing Bower

To install Bower, you have to have the Node package manager, i.e., *npm* installed on your system.

To install *npm*, go to the *Node.js* website (www.nodejs.org) and download the current version of *Node.js* for your system. It is a command line utility.

Install Bower as a global node module. To do so, use the following command:

```
C:\>npm install -g bower
```

 **Note:** Bower is a user command; there is no need to execute it with super user permissions.

Once the installation is complete, Bower is ready for use.

Creating the *bower.json* file

Bower uses a file called *bower.json* to keep track of all the

dependencies that are used in your project. To build a *bower.json* file, use the following command:

```
C:\>bower init
```

When you type this command, you will be asked a few questions and then you can initialise the *bower.json* file.

The description of the file properties of *bower.json* is as follows:

1. name – The name of your application
2. version – A version number for your application

By using Bower, we can add a new package to our project, automatically. Here, we will add Bootstrap to our project by using Bower. To install packages with Bower, use the following commands:

```
# install dependencies listed in bower.json
C:\> bower install
# install a package and add it to bower.json
C:\> bower install <package> -S
```

While installing packages using Bower, there may be a chance that we get this specific error:

```
ENOGIT git is not installed or not in the PATH
```